

Stop Spotter

Indicators & Analysis / Order Flow & Auction | advanced | 6 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

The Stop Spotter indicator identifies potential stop-loss hunting events — moments where price accelerates into a cluster of resting stop orders and triggers a cascade. It analyzes delta, volume, price action, candle body size and imbalances together, and prints a marker on the bar when all of your thresholds are met at once.

Because a genuine stop run leaves a very specific footprint (a sudden volume spike, one-sided aggression, consecutive imbalances and a fast directional body), requiring several conditions simultaneously filters out ordinary momentum bars and leaves you with the candidates worth trading.

What it is

Stop Spotter is a multi-condition orderflow signal indicator. Each of its main parameters is a minimum threshold — for delta percentage, total volume, volume increase, body size, price movement, horizontal delta, and imbalance count and size — and a bar is marked only when every enabled condition is satisfied. It answers the question "did this bar behave like a stop cascade, or is it just a normal push?"

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Chart window with Stop Spotter applied — a fast directional candle breaking a recent swing low with a square marker printed on it, surrounding bars unmarked, showing that only the stop-run candidate is flagged `dc-en-stop-spotter-01.png`

When to use it

- You trade reversals after liquidity grabs: a stop run into an obvious level that immediately stalls is a classic fade setup.
- You trade continuation through stops: a confirmed cascade can fuel the next leg, and the marker tells you the fuel was real.
- You want an objective, threshold-based definition of "stop hunt" instead of eyeballing wicks.
- You want to be alerted in real time when a stop-hunting condition fires, without watching every bar.

Quick start

1. Open the **Indicator List** on your chart.
2. Find **Stop Spotter** and click **+** to add it.
3. Click the **Settings** icon next to the indicator.
4. Keep the default thresholds on your first run — **Min. delta % 25**, **Min. volume 1500**, **Min. volume increase 500**, **Min. body ticks 6** — and observe how often markers print on your instrument.
5. If markers are too frequent, raise **Min. volume** and **Min. % imbalance** first; if they are too rare, lower **Min. body ticks**.
6. Optionally enable the alert sound and message popup in the alert options so signals reach you when you are not watching the chart.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Stop Spotter settings dialog showing the main parameters list — Min. delta %, Min. volume, Min. volume increase, Min. body ticks, Min price ticks increase, Min. horizontal delta, Min. % imbalance, Min. number imbalance, Calculation Mode and Seconds To Close — with their default values visible `dc-en-stop-spotter-02.png`

Note: The defaults are calibrated thresholds, not universal truths. Volume-based minimums in particular (**Min. volume**, **Min. volume increase**) depend heavily on the instrument and session you trade, so expect to tune them.

How to read it

- **Marker direction.** The **Color** setting marks upward stop runs and 2° **Color** marks downward stop runs, so the marker color tells you which side's stops were hit.
- **Location is everything.** A marker printed while price sweeps an obvious swing high/low, a session extreme, or a well-watched level is far more meaningful than one in the middle of a range. The indicator finds the footprint; you supply the context.
- **What happens next decides the trade.** If price reverses sharply after the marker, the cascade found no follow-through — a potential exhaustion/fade. If price keeps extending with fresh aggression, the stops became fuel for continuation.
- **Early signals.** With **Seconds To Close** at its default of 15, the indicator performs its calculations that many seconds before the bar closes, so a marker can appear slightly before the bar completes. Earlier warning comes at the cost of the occasional condition that fails in the final seconds.

Settings reference

Grouped as in the settings dialog.

Main Parameters

Setting	Default	What it does
Min. delta %	25	Minimum difference between buying and selling volume, as a percentage, that signals the directional pressure typical of stop-hunting activity.
Min. volume	1500	Minimum volume a bar must trade to be considered for stop-hunting detection; filters out low-activity periods.
Min. volume increase	500	Minimum volume increase compared to recent bars required to trigger a signal; identifies sudden participation spikes.
Min. body ticks	6	Minimum candle body size in ticks for a bar to qualify; a stop cascade produces a strong directional body.
Min price ticks increase	1	Minimum price movement in ticks required to identify a stop-hunting event.
Min. horizontal delta	60	Minimum difference between bid and ask volume at specific price levels; identifies concentrated aggressive trading.
Min. % imbalance	200%	Minimum percentage imbalance between bid and ask volume, indicating the one-sided order flow typical of stop cascades.
Min. number imbalance	2	Minimum number of consecutive imbalances required to confirm the event, for stronger confirmation.
Calculation Mode	Close	Determines which price level is used for calculations and where the signal is placed on the chart.
Seconds To Close	15	Number of seconds before bar close when the indicator performs its calculations, enabling earlier signals.

Contract Calculation

Enables an on-chart contract calculation display next to detected events, so you can translate a signal into position size.

Setting	What it does
Max loss	The maximum loss used as the position-sizing input.
Tick value divider	Divider applied with the instrument's tick value in the size calculation.
Font size	Size of the calculation text.
Back color / text colors	Background and text colors of the calculation display.

Visual Settings

Setting	Default	What it does
Subgraph Style	Square	Marker shape for detected events: square, circle, diamond, cross or triangle.
Color	—	Marker color for upward stop runs.
2° Color	—	Marker color for downward stop runs.
Line Style / Line Width	—	Border style and thickness of the markers.
Short Name	—	Custom label for the indicator on the chart.

Alert Options

Setting	What it does
Alert sound	Plays a sound notification when the conditions are detected.
Message popup	Shows an on-screen popup when the conditions are detected.

Tips and common mistakes

- **Tune one threshold at a time.** With eight interacting minimums, changing several at once makes it impossible to know which edit changed your signal count. Adjust, observe a session, then adjust again.
- **Do not treat every marker as a reversal signal.** A stop run is a liquidity event, not a direction call. Cascades resolve as both exhaustion and continuation — read the reaction, and confirm with the tape or a footprint such as Deep Print (Footprint).
- **Volume thresholds are instrument-specific.** 1500 contracts means something entirely different on a major index future than on a thin contract. Recalibrate **Min. volume** and **Min. volume increase** whenever you switch instruments.
- **Watch for signals near obvious liquidity pools.** Prior day highs/lows, overnight extremes and round numbers are where stops cluster; combine the marker with a levels tool such as Important Levels to pre-mark the hunting grounds.

Related articles

- Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta
- Understanding Icebergs and Absorption
- Big Trades
- Imbalance Tracker

- Different Types of Input Data for Indicators
- How to Change the Layout of Indicators